

The Jagala Waterfall

Location Jõelähtme municipality, Estonia

Estonia’s largest waterfall, on the Jagala River not far from where it enters the Gulf of Finland, is 25 ft (8m) high and more than 165 ft (50m) wide. Downstream, the river runs through a small gorge 980 ft (300m) long, charting the slow movement of the waterfall upstream as a result of erosion of the tough

limestone bedrock. In winter, the waterfall freezes, creating a tunnel between it and the rock behind.

Loch Ness

Location The Great Glen of Scotland, northern UK

Loch Ness is a deep, narrow freshwater lake that runs 23 miles (37km) along the bottom of the Great Glen, a straight valley

created by the Great Glen Fault and later scoured by glaciation. The greatest depth of Loch Ness is 750 ft (230 m). The Great Glen Fault is an ancient strike-slip fault, with crust to the north moving northeast relative to the south. It is now mostly inactive.

Lough Derg

Location Clare, Galway, and Tipperary counties, Republic of Ireland

This long, thin lake is the second biggest in the Republic of Ireland. It is both fed and emptied by the Shannon River. The lough is 24 miles (39km) long and covers an area of 50 square miles (130 square km). While its average depth is only 25 ft (8m), the deepest point is 118 ft (36 m)—the result of the deepening of the Shannon valley by glaciers during the last ice age.

The Severn

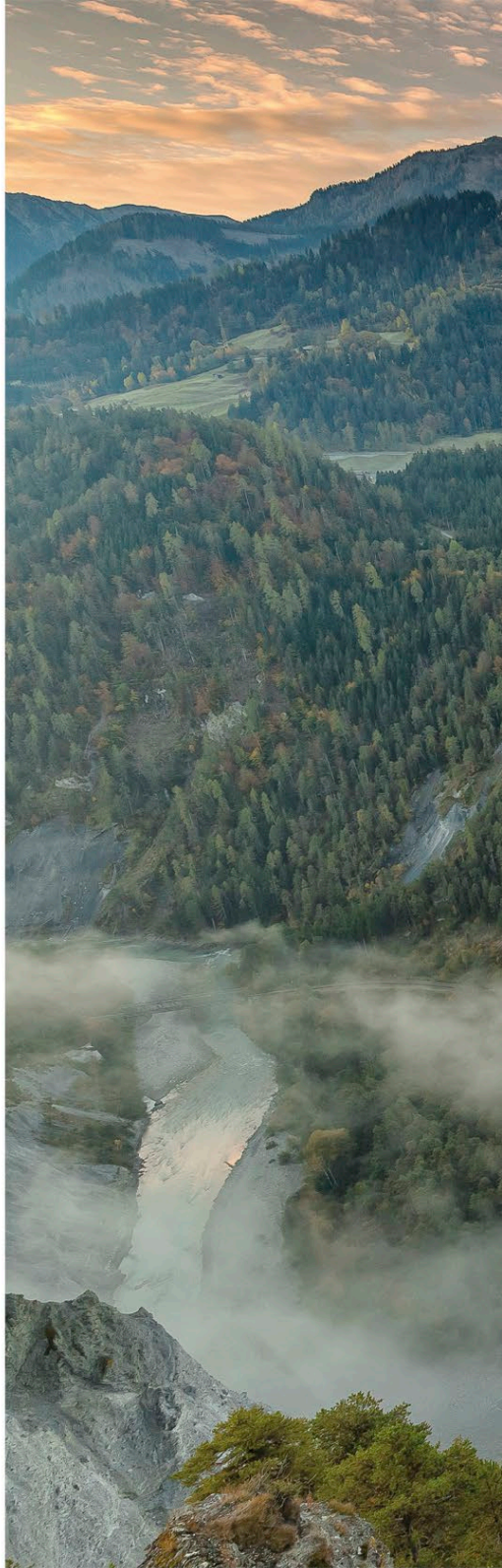
Location From the Cambrian Mountains to the Bristol Channel, UK

This is the longest river in the United Kingdom, at 220 miles (354km). It also has the largest discharge, averaging 2,100 cubic feet (60 cubic meters) per second but occasionally many times more than this. Its source is the upland of Plynlimon, in Wales, and it discharges into a tidal estuary and the Bristol Channel. The latter has a large tidal range, and during the highest tides, rising water is funneled up the lower reaches of the river, against the river current; this phenomenon is known as the Severn Bore.

The Thames

Location From the Cotswold Hills to the North Sea, UK

The Thames is the second longest river in the United Kingdom, generally accepted



as 215 miles (346km) long. Its source is in the Cotswold Hills, and it flows roughly east, through London, to empty into a broad estuary and the North Sea. Huge quantities of water are removed for domestic and industrial use, so its discharge is significantly less than that of the Severn (see left). However, it poses a considerable threat. Heavy rains combined with exceptionally high tides have flooded the city on many occasions. The lowest 55-mile- (89-km-) long stretch of the river, to Teddington Lock, is tidal.



▲ FROZEN WATER AT THE JAGALA WATERFALL